

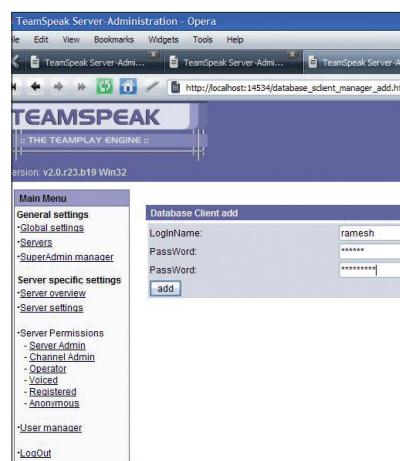
like you have to pay for this service, look for a link that says “Compare to Standard Edition”. when you click this, you will see a “Get Started” button under “Standard Edition”. From here on you can just follow instructions, and get over 7 GB email space for up to 50 users.

Other tips

There are other things you can try, like printing on both sides of the paper. You save money and the environment! Some printers automatically print on both sides of the paper. If your printer does not, use the “print on both sides” mode, where you only have to manually reverse the stack after one side is printed. Also, avoid printing unless absolutely required. If you must print, then print in draft / economy mode by default.

So far we have told you what you can, and should do, to cut corners. But while running leaner is a must, not every penny-pinching measure is a good one — so here are some strict No-Nos. Certain things are really based on common sense. For example, if your business relies on a web face then don't compromise on that front. Follow these set of instructions and you should be well on your way to frugality in these trying times. ☑

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Teamspeak setup

Using Power Management

To change the power management settings for your PC, go to Start > Control Panel > Click Power Options. Set the Turn off monitor to After 5 minutes, and turn off hard disks to After 10 minutes, and standby to 15 minutes. This will significantly save electricity.

Skype Setup

To communicate between branches of your office, make sure you have Skype downloaded and installed on the PCs in your office. You can also have conference calls between offices using Skype. Upto 24 employees can join these conference calls. Click on Call > Start Conference Call. Add users from your contacts and click on start.

TeamSpeak

TeamSpeak is an application that allows you to host a voice server on your PC. You can connect to this server and have a voice chat / conference. The application is actually meant for gaming purposes, but can be put to commercial use. It's free and works effectively on LAN. So in case you have an office, which is on different levels or floors this could be a useful utility. It's like having a conference call on, all the time which is something not even possible on a telephone-based intercom. To setup, download TeamSpeak client as well as TeamSpeak server from www.teamSpeak.com. While installing the server, you will get a temporary username and password. Make a note of both admin and superadmin passwords. These passwords can be changed to your preference later. Once installed, the TeamSpeak server will minimise to the system tray. Right-click on it and click on Administration. The server is managed through a web interface, so a browser page will open where you need to put in your username as superadmin and password. Once within the interface, click on SuperAdmin manager in the left pane. Click on add client to create user accounts for all your employees. Assign user name and password for each employee. Once this is done install the TeamSpeak client on all your PCs. To connect to the server from another PC click on Connection > Connect in the TeamSpeak Client application. Add details of the server such as server IP address and nickname. Enter user name and password and click connect. The server's IP can be found out by right-clicking on the server icon in the system tray and moving the cursor over “Your IPs”.

Sharing the internet

To share an internet connection between multiple computers, a proxy software is required. Several solutions such as FreeProxy and AnalogX are available online. Download and install FreeProxy from www.handcraftedsoftware.org. It is simple, easy to use and also functions as a caching server and web site filter / blocker.

To Share a Connection using FreeProxy follow these steps:

Click on Define > Define Ports. Here you can define ports for Http, socks, etc. (Usually 8080, 1080 etc). Click on Done.

Now enter this in the browser's settings on the PCs connected to the network. Click on Start/Stop to activate proxy server. All PCs will now access the internet through this proxy server.

To Activate Caching:

Click on Define > Define Cache. Tick the Activate the cache check box. Select the control and data path. Enter the size limit of cache depending on usage. 300MB should be fine. Set the expiry to around 7 days. Click on Done.

To ban certain web sites:

Click on the Ban List button in the top bar. Click on New and create a category, say Bad. Click on Manage Category Details and add the URLs that you wish to block. Click Save, and then Activate > Done. Double-click on Ports and then on Permissions > Add Resource. In Resource type, select Ban-List URL or IP Address. Under Permission, select Forbidden for all users. Click Done. You can also add filters. To do this in resource type, select Full URL or Path Filter. Under path, you can type *download* to block all URLs containing the word download.